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The Acts Overlap Model

A Visual Guide to the Concurrent Operation of the Prophecy and Mystery Programs

During the book of Acts, two distinct divine programs operated concurrently—the **Prophecy Program for Israel** and the **Mystery Program for the Body of Christ**. Understanding their distinct identities, chronological boundaries, and concurrent operation during Acts 9–28 is essential to reading Acts without collapsing one program into the other.

How to read this guide: **gold** marks the Prophecy Program, **blue** marks the Mystery Program, and **green** marks the Acts 9–28 overlap.

Timeline of Redemptive History

Two distinct programs. One concurrent Acts overlap.

BEFORE ACTS 9

Prophecy already in operation

ACTS 9

Mystery begins through Paul's calling and commission

ACTS 9–28

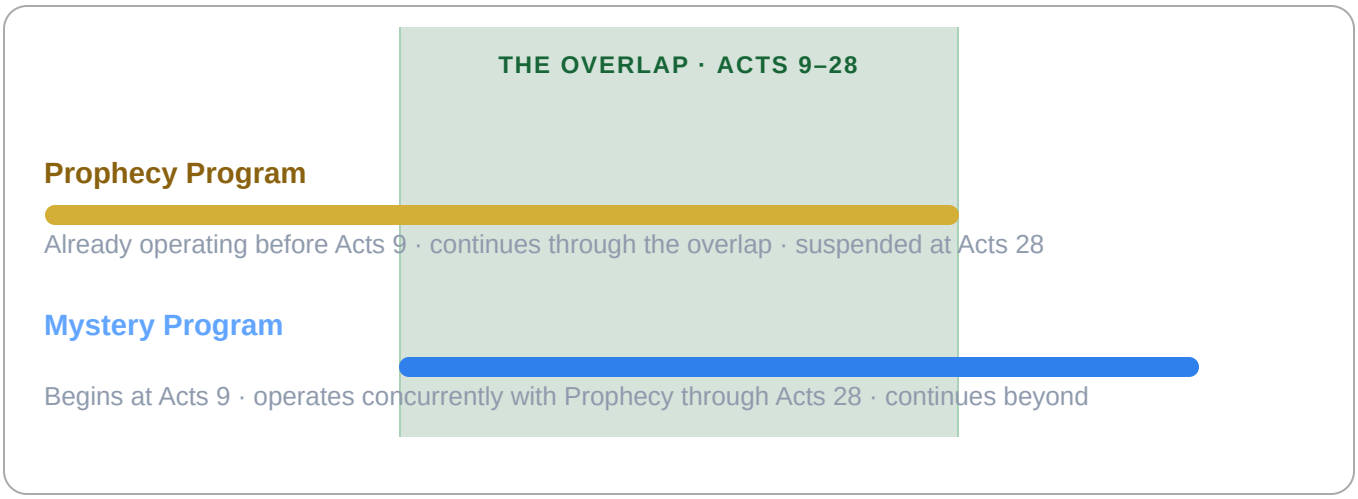
Both programs operate concurrently

ACTS 28

Prophecy suspended

BEYOND ACTS 28

Mystery continues



The Five Phases

Expanded guide to the chronology and governing distinctions

Before Acts 9 — The Prophecy Program Already in Operation

PRE-ACTS 9 · PROPHECY PROGRAM ALREADY IN OPERATION

The Prophecy Program traces through Israel's covenants and prophetic promises, centered in Israel as a nation.

KEY FEATURES

- The Kingdom of Heaven promised to Israel
- Messiah's coming foretold through the prophets
- National covenant promises remain in view
- The Twelve commissioned within Israel's prophetic program

Genesis 12:1–3 · Isaiah 9:6–7 · Jeremiah 31:31–34 · Matthew 10:5–6

Acts 1–8 — The Kingdom Gospel to Israel

ACTS 1–8 · PROPHECY PROGRAM IN FULL OPERATION

Acts opens with the Prophecy Program in full operation. Peter and the Twelve address Israel, with Pentecost, signs, wonders, and the kingdom proclamation functioning within Israel's prophetic setting.

KEY FEATURES

- Pentecost and Joel's prophecy in Acts 2
- Signs and wonders confirm Israel's apostolic witness
- The kingdom message is presented to Israel
- Israel remains the primary national audience

Acts 2:16–21 · Acts 3:19–21 · Acts 5:12 · Acts 8:12

Acts 9 — The Mystery Revealed Through Paul

ACTS 9 · MYSTERY PROGRAM BEGINS

Acts 9 marks the beginning of Paul's distinctive calling and commission. The Mystery Program, hidden since the world began, is revealed through Paul and concerns the Body of Christ.

KEY FEATURES

- Paul's distinctive apostleship does not make him one of the Twelve
- Jew and Gentile are joined in one Body of Christ
- A heavenly calling and position distinct from Israel's earthly kingdom
- The Mystery is revealed through Paul

Acts 9:1–16 · Ephesians 3:1–9 · Galatians 1:11–12 · Romans 16:25–26

Acts 9–28 — Two Programs Operating Concurrently

THE ACTS OVERLAP

During Acts 9–28, the Prophecy Program for Israel and the Mystery Program for the Body of Christ operate side-by-side. Each retains its own audience, message, calling, promises, and divine purpose.

PROPHECY PROGRAM DURING ACTS

- Peter and the Twelve remain active in Israel's program
- Signs and Jewish observances continue within the Prophecy setting

MYSTERY PROGRAM DURING ACTS

- Paul's ministry among the nations expands
- The Body of Christ is formed and grows

Acts 13:46 · Acts 18:6 · Acts 9:17–26 · Romans 1:16

Acts 28 & Beyond — Mystery Continues

POST-ACTS 28 · PROPHECY SUSPENDED · MYSTERY CONTINUES

At Acts 28 Israel's Prophecy Program reaches its suspension point. The Mystery Program continues beyond Acts 28 while Israel awaits the future fulfillment of her prophetic promises.

KEY FEATURES

- Paul's later epistles further define the Mystery Program
- The Body of Christ retains its distinct heavenly calling
- Prophecy is suspended, not cancelled
- Mystery continues until God's purpose for the Body of Christ is complete

Acts 28:28 · Ephesians 1:9–10 · Ephesians 3:6 · Colossians 1:26–27

Prophecy Program vs. Mystery Program

At a Glance

Feature	Prophecy Program	Mystery Program
Apostle(s)	Peter & the Twelve	Paul
Audience	Israel (Nation)	The Body of Christ — Jew and Gentile without national distinction
Program Basis	Covenant and prophetic promises	Mystery hidden since the world began; revealed through Paul
Hope	Earthly kingdom promises centered in Israel	Heavenly position and calling in Christ
Signs & Miracles	Confirming signs within Israel's program	Present during the Acts overlap; not the defining basis of the Mystery Program
Water Baptism	Part of Israel's kingdom program	Not a defining ordinance of the Body of Christ program
Primary Source Emphasis	Law and Prophets · Gospels · Acts · Hebrews–Revelation	Romans–Philemon
Status after Acts 28	Suspended at Acts 28	Continues beyond Acts 28

“Study to show thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.”

— 2 Timothy 2:15 (KJV)

Legend

- **Gold** = Prophecy Program
- **Blue** = Mystery Program
- **Green** = Acts 9–28 Concurrent Overlap

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